were so hostile to the young English king that he left after just weeks and went to Normandy instead.

The English position in France was further complicated by a falling-out between the English regent and his longtime ally, the Duke of Burgundy. With the resurgence of Charles VII's power, the Duke of Burgundy had been contemplating how he could be reconciled to his king. When his sister, the Duke of Bedford's wife, died in 1432 and Bedford quickly remarried, the two men were pushed even further apart. "The English became very suspicious of the Burgundians," Monstrelet says, "and guarded as much against them as they had done before against the French . . . and they no longer had confidence in each other."[17]

The English had been pushed hard back on their heels, and in the late summer of 1435, Henry VI's London council agreed to send ambassadors to Arras to meet with two cardinals sent from Rome to help establish a peace between the warring kings. The Duke of Burgundy was also in attendance, as were representatives from a number of French countries; Charles VII sent diplomats of his own. The Duke of Bedford remained away; and it soon became clear that the only useful negotiations were going on between the Duke of Burgundy and Charles VII's men. The English were "not well pleased . . . for they suspected some treaties were in agitation that would not be for the advantage of their country." In addition to secret meetings between the French parties, the English ambassadors were continually faced with the French demand that King Henry give up the claim to be king of France, in exchange for sovereignty over certain French territories. By early September, they were fed up. They abandoned the talks and returned to England.[18]

Just a few days later, the Duke of Bedford, who had been lying ill at Rouen, died. The Duke of Burgundy now concluded that any obligation to the English was at an end. On September 21, he agreed to sign the Treaty of Arras; this did nothing to bring the war with the English to an end, but it reunified the Burgundian party to the crown, bringing an end to the split that had allowed the English to make a play for France in the first place.

Paris itself resisted a little longer; there were die-hard Burgundians in the city who were still unwilling to follow their duke into the French king's fold; and there was still an English force holding the Bastille. Finally, early in 1436, a French royal army under the command of the Constable of France broke through the gates, surrounded the Bastille, and forced the remaining holdouts to surrender.

Charles VII himself entered the city on November 12, 1437. He had not been in his own capital city for nineteen years, and the date was carefully chosen; it was the first Sunday in Advent, the beginning of the season of the